

Subordinate Clauses in Greek

I. TEMPORAL CLAUSES [Smyth 2383-2461]

A. When, relative to the main verb?

1. Same time as main verb

a) *When?* ὅτε, ὁπότε, ἡνίκα

b) *While* ἕως

2. Prior to

a) *After/when* ἐπεί, ἐπείδη

3. Subsequent to

a) *Until* ἕως, μέχρι

b) *Before* πρίν [takes the indicative when the principal clause is negative; infinitive when positive]

B. Present and past temporal clauses take the indicative mood when the action is marked as a fact and refers to a definite occasion.

C. Future temporal clauses take the subjunctive or optative with ἄν.

II. CAUSAL [2240-2248]

A. ὅτι, ἐπεί, ἐπείδη, ὅτε, ὥς = because, since

1. Neg = οὐ

2. Fact = indicative

III. PURPOSE CLAUSES [FINAL CLAUSES] [Smyth 2193-2206]

A. ἵνα, ὅπως, ὥς

B. Negated by μή

C. Subjunctive after primary tenses

D. Optative after secondary tenses

IV. OBJECT CLAUSES

A. Of EFFORT [Smyth 2209-2219]

1. *to take care, take pains, strive*

2. ὅπως, negated by μή

3. Take future indicative for the most part

B. Of FEARING [Smyth 2221-2239]

1. Introduces by μή (*lest*) or μή οὐ (*lest not*)

2. Subjunctive after primary tenses

3. Optative after secondary tenses

4. Fear about the present or past takes indicative

V. RESULT [2249-2278]

A. ὥστε = so that

1. Often refers back to a demonstrative adverb/adjective in the main clause: οὕτως (*thus*) τοιοῦτος (*such*), τοσοῦτος (*so great*)

2. Usually takes the infinitive to explain the main thought with an anticipated or possible result

B. Rarely takes the indicative to explain an actual result.

VI. COMPARISON CLAUSES [2462-2487]

- A. Take indicative for statements of fact
- B. ὥς, ὅπως (as), ὥσπερ, καθόπερ (just as)
- C. Principal clause often contains a demonstrative adverb

VII. Some Conditionals

- A. Present Simple εἰ + pr/pf indic + pr/pf indic
 - 1. A simple assertion with no indication of its reality or probability. A truism.
 - 2. If he buys a boat, he can trade more easily.
- B. Past Simple εἰ + impf/aor/pp indic + impf/aor/pp indic
 - 1. If he bought a boat, he was smart.
- C. Present Unreal εἰ + impf indic + impf indic + ἄν
 - 1. An unreal assertion
 - 2. ἄν
 - 3. If he were buying a boat, he would have an excuse for being late.
- D. Past Unreal εἰ + impf/aor indic + aor/impf indic + ἄν
 - 1. If he had bought a boat, he would be home by now